

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Mineral	Hardness (Mohs scale)
Talc	1
Gypsum	2
Fluorite	4
Quartz	7

A geology student is comparing the hardness of common minerals. The table shows that the hardness of fluorite on the Mohs scale is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: 2, the same as gypsum.

B: 4.

C: 7, the highest value in the table.

D: 1, the lowest value in the table.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Fluorite's row shows hardness 4. A gives gypsum's value, C gives quartz's value, D gives talc's value. TRICK: Match the mineral name to its own row -- don't be pulled to the highest or lowest value.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Bird species	Average wingspan (cm)
Eurasian jay	54
Common starling	38
Barn swallow	33
House sparrow	24

An ornithologist recorded the average wingspans of four bird species commonly found in suburban parks in northern Europe.

According to the table, what is the average wingspan, in centimeters, of the common starling?

A: 24

B: 33

C: 38

D: 54

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Common starling row = 38 cm. A is the house sparrow, B is the barn swallow (adjacent row -- easy misread), D is the Eurasian jay. TRICK: Read from the correct row; the adjacent species are the trap.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Country	% of electricity from wind power (2022)
Denmark	55.2
Ireland	33.5
Portugal	26.4
Germany	22.1

An energy analyst is examining how much of each country's electricity came from wind power in 2022. The table shows that the percentage of electricity generated from wind power in Portugal was _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: 26.4%.

B: 33.5%.

C: 55.2%.

D: 22.1%.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Portugal row = 26.4%. B is Ireland (adjacent row), C is Denmark, D is Germany.

TRICK: Read the Portugal row directly.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Whale species	Estimated population
North Atlantic right whale	340
Blue whale	10,000
Humpback whale	84,000
Gray whale	27,000

Marine biologists track the estimated populations of several whale species. The species with the largest estimated population is the _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: gray whale, with an estimated population of 27,000.

B: blue whale, with an estimated population of 10,000.

C: North Atlantic right whale, with an estimated population of 340.

D: humpback whale, with an estimated population of 84,000.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 84,000 is the largest number. A (gray whale 27,000) is the second-largest -- the strongest distractor. TRICK: Compare all four numbers before answering; the second-largest value is always the trap.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Telescope	Year	Primary mirror diameter (m)
Hale	1949	5.1
Keck I	1993	10.0
Gran Telescopio Canarias	2009	10.4
Vera C. Rubin Observatory	2025	8.4

An astronomy student is researching the history of large optical telescopes.

According to the table, what is the primary mirror diameter, in meters, of the Gran Telescopio Canarias?

A: 5.1

B: 8.4

C: 10.4

D: 10.0

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Gran Telescopio Canarias row = 10.4 m. D (Keck I = 10.0) is the trap -- students confuse the two similarly named large telescopes. TRICK: 10.0 vs 10.4 -- read the correct row carefully.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

City	Avg January temp (deg F)	Avg July temp (deg F)
Fairbanks	-7	63
Anchorage	16	58
Juneau	28	56
Sitka	33	55

A climatologist notes that among the four Alaskan cities listed, the city with the highest average January temperature is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: Sitka, at 33 deg F.

B: Juneau, at 28 deg F.

C: Fairbanks, at 63 deg F.

D: Anchorage, at 16 deg F.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Highest January temp: Sitka at 33. C is the trap -- Fairbanks at 63 is the highest JULY temperature. Students who read the wrong column pick C. TRICK: Check the column header. January, not July.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Nutrient	Per 100g raw kale	Per 100g raw spinach
Vitamin C (mg)	93	28
Calcium (mg)	254	99
Iron (mg)	1.6	2.7
Fiber (g)	4.1	2.2

A nutritionist is comparing the nutrient content of kale and spinach. She notes that raw spinach contains more of one nutrient per 100 g than raw kale does: _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: vitamin C, at 93 mg in kale compared to 28 mg in spinach.

B: calcium, at 254 mg in kale compared to 99 mg in spinach.

C: fiber, at 4.1 g in kale compared to 2.2 g in spinach.

D: iron, at 2.7 mg in spinach compared to 1.6 mg in kale.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Only iron is higher in spinach ($2.7 > 1.6$). A, B, and C all show kale higher -- they state TRUE data but answer the WRONG question. TRICK: The question asks where spinach > kale, not kale > spinach. Read the direction of the comparison.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Volcano	Last eruption	Elevation (m)
Mount Pelee	1932	1,397
Soufriere Hills	2010	1,050
La Grande Soufriere	1977	1,467
Mount Scenery	Unknown	887

A geologist is studying Caribbean volcanoes.

According to the table, which volcano has the highest elevation?

A: Mount Pelee, at 1,397 m

B: La Grande Soufriere, at 1,467 m

C: Soufriere Hills, at 1,050 m

D: Mount Scenery, at 887 m

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 1,467 is the largest elevation. A (1,397) is close and the strongest distractor. TRICK: 1,397 vs 1,467 -- compare carefully when values differ by less than 100.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Material	Thermal conductivity (W/m.K)
Copper	385
Aluminum	205
Stainless steel	16
Glass	1.0

An engineer is selecting materials for a heat exchanger. The table shows that the material with the lowest thermal conductivity is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: stainless steel, at 16 W/m.K.

B: aluminum, at 205 W/m.K.

C: glass, at 1.0 W/m.K.

D: copper, at 385 W/m.K.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Glass at 1.0 is the lowest. A (stainless steel at 16) is the trap -- it's the second-lowest, and students may confuse 'lowest thermal conductivity' with 'lowest among metals.' TRICK: Include ALL materials, not just metals.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: [Table]

Rover	Landing year	Mass (kg)
Sojourner	1997	11.5
Spirit	2004	185
Curiosity	2012	899
Perseverance	2021	1,025

A space historian is examining how the mass of Mars rovers has changed over time. For the rover that landed in 2012, for example, the mass was _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: 899 kg.

B: 185 kg.

C: 1,025 kg.

D: 11.5 kg.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 2012 = Curiosity = 899 kg. C (1,025) is Perseverance (2021) -- students who look at the wrong year pick this. TRICK: Match the YEAR first, then read across to mass.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Crop	Yield/hectare (tonnes), 2018	Yield/hectare (tonnes), 2023
Rice	4.5	4.9
Wheat	3.4	3.3
Maize	5.9	6.7
Sorghum	1.4	1.6

Agricultural researchers tracked the yields of four staple crops over a five-year period. A student writing a report wants to identify the crop that showed the greatest absolute increase in yield per hectare between 2018 and 2023.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- A: rice, which increased from 4.5 to 4.9 tonnes per hectare, an increase of 0.4 tonnes.
- B: sorghum, which increased from 1.4 to 1.6 tonnes per hectare, an increase of 0.2 tonnes.
- C: wheat, which changed from 3.4 to 3.3 tonnes per hectare, a decrease of 0.1 tonnes.
- D: maize, which increased from 5.9 to 6.7 tonnes per hectare, an increase of 0.8 tonnes.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Maize: $6.7 - 5.9 = 0.8$ (largest absolute increase). A (rice $+0.4$) is tempting because it's still a sizable increase. B (sorghum) had the largest PERCENTAGE increase (14%) but smallest absolute. TRICK: 'Greatest absolute increase' = largest raw difference, not largest percentage change.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Enzyme	Optimal pH	Optimal temp (deg C)
Pepsin	2.0	37
Trypsin	8.0	37
Salivary amylase	6.8	37
Lipase	8.0	37

A biology student is comparing the environments in which digestive enzymes function most efficiently. The student notes that the two enzymes with the most similar optimal pH values are _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: pepsin and salivary amylase, with pH values of 2.0 and 6.8.

B: trypsin and lipase, with pH values of 8.0 and 8.0.

C: salivary amylase and lipase, with pH values of 6.8 and 8.0.

D: pepsin and trypsin, with pH values of 2.0 and 8.0.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trypsin and lipase both have pH 8.0 (identical = most similar). C (6.8 vs 8.0 = difference of 1.2) is the strongest distractor -- closer than A or D but not identical.

TRICK: 'Most similar' can mean identical. Scan for exact matches first.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Year	Published papers on microplastics
2010	120
2013	340
2016	1,450
2019	4,200
2022	9,800

Environmental scientist Priya Nair compiled data on the growth of academic research into microplastics contamination. Nair observed that between any two consecutive data points shown, the number of published papers more than doubled, indicating accelerating scientific interest.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Nair's observation?

A: The number of papers in 2022 was 9,800, which is greater than the number in any prior year.

B: The number of papers increased from 1,450 in 2016 to 4,200 in 2019, but the rate of increase slowed between 2019 and 2022.

C: The number of papers increased from 120 in 2010 to 340 in 2013, and from 340 in 2013 to 1,450 in 2016 -- in each case more than doubling.

D: The total number of papers across all years exceeds 15,000.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim is about DOUBLING between consecutive points. C shows two consecutive intervals where papers more than doubled ($120 \rightarrow 340 = 2.8x$; $340 \rightarrow 1450 = 4.3x$). A states a fact but doesn't show doubling. B actually WEAKENS the claim by suggesting slowdown. TRICK: 'Support the observation' means showing the pattern the scientist described, not just stating the largest number.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Language family	Living languages	% of world's languages
Niger-Congo	1,542	21.7
Austronesian	1,257	17.7
Trans-New Guinea	481	6.8
Sino-Tibetan	456	6.4

A linguistics student is writing a paper about the distribution of the world's languages. The student wants to emphasize that two language families together account for the greatest combined share.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- A: Niger-Congo and Austronesian, which together account for 39.4% of the world's languages.
- B: Niger-Congo and Sino-Tibetan, which together account for 28.1% of the world's languages.
- C: Austronesian and Trans-New Guinea, which together account for 24.5% of the world's languages.
- D: Trans-New Guinea and Sino-Tibetan, which together account for 13.2% of the world's languages.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: $21.7 + 17.7 = 39.4\%$ (largest pair). B (28.1%) is tempting because Niger-Congo is included, but pairing it with the third-largest is suboptimal. TRICK: The two largest individual shares always produce the largest combined share.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Pigment	Peak absorption (nm)	Color absorbed
Chlorophyll a	430	Violet-blue
Chlorophyll b	455	Blue
Beta-carotene	450	Blue
Phycoerythrin	565	Green

A plant biologist is investigating the light-harvesting properties of photosynthetic pigments. The biologist notes that among the pigments listed, the one that absorbs light at the longest wavelength is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: chlorophyll b, with a peak absorption at 455 nm.

B: beta-carotene, with a peak absorption at 450 nm.

C: chlorophyll a, with a peak absorption at 430 nm.

D: phycoerythrin, with a peak absorption at 565 nm.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 565 nm is the longest wavelength. A (455 nm) is the trap -- it's the second-longest and involves a similar pigment name. TRICK: 'Longest wavelength' = highest number in nm. Don't confuse with color names.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Museum	Visitors (millions), 2019	Visitors (millions), 2023
Louvre	9.6	8.9
National Gallery (London)	6.0	5.7
Met (New York)	6.5	5.4
Uffizi (Florence)	4.4	5.1

A cultural researcher observed that most major art museums saw declines in annual visitors between 2019 and 2023, but one museum bucked this trend.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate the researcher's point?

A: the Louvre received 9.6 million visitors in 2019 but only 8.9 million in 2023, a decrease of 0.7 million.

B: the Uffizi received 4.4 million visitors in 2019 and 5.1 million in 2023, an increase of 0.7 million, while the other three museums experienced declines.

C: the Met saw the largest decline, dropping from 6.5 million in 2019 to 5.4 million in 2023, a decrease of 1.1 million.

D: the National Gallery received 6.0 million visitors in 2019, making it the second most visited museum that year.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Bucked this trend' = the one that INCREASED. Only Uffizi went up (4.4 to 5.1).

A and C show declines (true facts but they illustrate the TREND, not the exception). D is irrelevant to the trend. TRICK: 'Bucked the trend' means the exception, not the rule.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Soil type	Water retention (%)	Avg crop yield (kg/sq m)
Clay	45	3.2
Silt	38	4.1
Sandy loam	25	3.8
Sand	12	1.9

Agricultural scientist Dr. Tomas Herrera hypothesized that soils with higher water retention capacity consistently produce higher crop yields.

Which choice best describes data from the table that weaken Dr. Herrera's hypothesis?

- A: Sand has both the lowest water retention capacity and the lowest average crop yield, which supports the hypothesis.
- B: Silt has a higher water retention capacity than sandy loam, and silt also has a higher crop yield, which is consistent with the hypothesis.
- C: Clay has the highest water retention capacity but does not have the highest average crop yield; silt, with a lower retention capacity, yields more.
- D: Sandy loam has a higher water retention capacity than sand and also a higher crop yield, consistent with the hypothesis.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The question asks what WEAKENS the hypothesis. Only C shows a case where higher retention does NOT produce higher yield (clay 45%/3.2 vs silt 38%/4.1). A, B, and D all SUPPORT the hypothesis. TRICK: 'Weaken' means find a counterexample -- a case where the predicted pattern breaks down.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Asteroid	Diameter (km)	Orbital period (yr)	Albedo
Pallas	512	4.6	0.16
Hygiea	434	5.6	0.07
Interamnia	332	5.4	0.07
Europa (asteroid) 303		5.5	0.06

A planetary scientist notes that among the four asteroids listed, the two with the most similar albedo values are _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: Hygiea and Interamnia, which both have an albedo of 0.07.

B: Interamnia and Europa, with albedos of 0.07 and 0.06.

C: Pallas and Hygiea, with albedos of 0.16 and 0.07.

D: Pallas and Europa, with albedos of 0.16 and 0.06.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Hygiea and Interamnia both have albedo 0.07 (identical). B (0.07 vs 0.06 = difference of 0.01) is close but not identical. TRICK: Identical values are always 'most similar.' Scan for exact matches first.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Treatment group	Participants	% reporting symptom relief
Standard dose	150	62%
Double dose	150	64%
Placebo	150	58%

Pharmacologist Reina Okamura conducted a trial of a new anti-inflammatory compound. Okamura concluded that doubling the dosage did not produce a meaningful advantage over the standard dose.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Okamura's conclusion?

- A: Only 58% of participants in the placebo group reported symptom relief, compared to 62% in the standard dose group, indicating the drug is effective.
- B: The double dose group and the standard dose group reported similar rates of symptom relief, at 64% and 62%, respectively -- a difference of only 2 percentage points.
- C: More participants in the double dose group reported symptom relief than in the placebo group, suggesting the higher dose has some effect.
- D: Each treatment group had the same number of participants (150), ensuring the comparison is fair.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Okamura's claim: doubling the dose gives no meaningful advantage OVER STANDARD. B directly compares double vs. standard (64% vs 62% = tiny difference). A compares standard vs. placebo (different claim). C compares double vs. placebo (different claim). TRICK: Match the comparison in the claim -- 'double vs. standard,' not 'drug vs. placebo.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Region	Forest cover (%), 2000	Forest cover (%), 2020
South America	51.4	46.2
Sub-Saharan Africa	29.8	25.9
Southeast Asia	49.8	46.1
Northern Europe	53.1	54.6

An environmental policy analyst wants to identify the region that experienced the largest percentage-point decrease in forest cover between 2000 and 2020.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

- A: Sub-Saharan Africa, which experienced a decrease of 3.9 percentage points.
- B: Southeast Asia, which experienced a decrease of 3.7 percentage points.
- C: Northern Europe, which experienced an increase of 1.5 percentage points.
- D: South America, which experienced a decrease of 5.2 percentage points.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: South America: $51.4 - 46.2 = 5.2$ (largest decrease). A (Sub-Saharan Africa 3.9) is the trap -- students may focus on the lowest starting value rather than the largest drop. C is wrong direction (increase). TRICK: Subtract 2020 from 2000 for each region and compare the differences.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Building material	Embodied carbon (kg CO ₂ /kg)	Compressive strength (MPa)
Conventional concrete	0.13	30
Geopolymer concrete	0.06	28
Cross-laminated timber	0.05	25
Recycled steel	0.47	250

Civil engineer Amara Osei concluded that geopolymer concrete offers a better balance of lower environmental impact and structural performance compared to cross-laminated timber.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Osei's conclusion?

A: Geopolymer concrete has lower embodied carbon than conventional concrete and similar compressive strength.

B: Cross-laminated timber has the lowest embodied carbon among all four materials at 0.05 kg CO₂/kg.

C: Geopolymer concrete has slightly higher embodied carbon than cross-laminated timber (0.06 vs 0.05) but notably higher compressive strength (28 vs 25 MPa).

D: Recycled steel has the highest compressive strength but also the highest embodied carbon.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Osei compares geopolymer vs. timber on BOTH metrics. C shows the trade-off: slightly more carbon but better strength. A compares geopolymer to CONVENTIONAL concrete (wrong comparison). B only addresses one metric. TRICK: The claim compares two specific materials -- the answer must compare those same two materials on both stated criteria.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Fish species	Avg length (cm)	Avg weight (g)	Depth range (m)
Spotted goby	6	2	1-15
Sand smelt	14	18	0-20
Lesser weever	15	50	1-50
Rock cook wrasse	18	65	1-30

A marine ecologist notes that the species with the widest depth range is _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: the lesser weever, which inhabits depths from 1 to 50 m, a range of 49 m.

B: the rock cook wrasse, which inhabits depths from 1 to 30 m, a range of 29 m.

C: the sand smelt, which inhabits depths from 0 to 20 m, a range of 20 m.

D: the spotted goby, which inhabits depths from 1 to 15 m, a range of 14 m.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Lesser weever: $50 - 1 = 49$ m range (widest). B (rock cook wrasse: 29 m) is the trap -- it has the deepest maximum depth among the other three. C (sand smelt: 20 m) starts at 0, which might seem special. TRICK: 'Widest range' = largest difference between max and min depth.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Novel	Year published	Approx word count
Middlemarch	1871	316,000
Bleak House	1853	530,000
War and Peace	1869	580,000
Les Miserables	1862	360,000

A literature student wants to show that the two longest novels were not written in the same decade.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to accomplish the student's goal?

A: Les Miserables (approx 360,000 words) was published in 1862, and Middlemarch (approx 316,000 words) was published in 1871 -- different decades but not the two longest.

B: Bleak House (approx 530,000 words) was published in 1853, and Middlemarch (approx 316,000 words) was published in 1871.

C: War and Peace (approx 580,000 words) was published in 1869, while Les Miserables (approx 360,000 words) was published in 1862 -- both in the 1860s.

D: War and Peace (approx 580,000 words) was published in 1869, while Bleak House (approx 530,000 words) was published in 1853 -- different decades.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The TWO LONGEST are War and Peace (580k) and Bleak House (530k). D correctly identifies both and shows they were in different decades (1860s vs 1850s). A uses the wrong pair (not the longest). C shows two novels in the SAME decade (weakens the claim). TRICK: First identify the two longest by word count, THEN check their decades.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Insulation type	R-value/inch	Cost/sq ft (\$)
Fiberglass batts	3.2	0.64
Cellulose (blown-in)	3.7	0.82
Spray foam (closed-cell)	6.5	1.50
Mineral wool	3.3	1.10

A homeowner wants the highest R-value per inch but is also concerned about cost. She notes that spray foam has the highest R-value but is the most expensive. She considers whether mineral wool might be a reasonable compromise and observes that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the homeowner's observation?

A: mineral wool has a lower R-value per inch than cellulose but costs more per square foot, making it an unfavorable compromise.

B: mineral wool has a higher R-value per inch than fiberglass batts (3.3 vs 3.2) but costs less per square foot than spray foam (\$1.10 vs \$1.50).

C: mineral wool has the same R-value per inch as fiberglass batts and costs \$1.10 per square foot.

D: cellulose has a higher R-value per inch (3.7) and a lower cost (\$0.82) than mineral wool, making cellulose the better compromise.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: A 'compromise' means better than the cheapest option on performance but cheaper than the best performer. B shows mineral wool beats fiberglass on R-value and costs less than spray foam -- it's in the middle. A and D actually argue AGAINST mineral wool as a compromise. C states incorrect data (3.3 is not 3.2). TRICK: A compromise must be shown to have advantages on BOTH sides of the trade-off.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

River	Length (km)	Avg discharge (cu m/s)
Lena	4,400	16,350
Yenisei	3,487	19,600
Ob	5,410	12,475
Amur	2,824	10,900

A geography student wants to point out that the river with the greatest average discharge is not the longest river in the table.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support the student's point?

A: The Yenisei has the greatest average discharge at 19,600 cu m/s, yet at 3,487 km it is shorter than the Ob, which at 5,410 km is the longest river in the table.

B: The Lena is 4,400 km long and has an average discharge of 16,350 cu m/s, making it neither the longest nor the river with the greatest discharge.

C: The Ob is the longest river at 5,410 km, and the Amur is the shortest at 2,824 km with the lowest average discharge.

D: The Yenisei has the greatest average discharge at 19,600 cu m/s, and it is also the longest river in the table.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim: greatest discharge is NOT the longest. A shows Yenisei (greatest discharge) is shorter than Ob (longest). D CONTRADICTS the claim by incorrectly stating Yenisei is longest. B and C state true facts but don't establish the disconnect. TRICK: D contains a factual error -- always verify data claims against the table.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Element	Melting point (deg C)	Boiling point (deg C)	Density (g/cu cm)
Gallium	29.8	2,204	5.91
Cesium	28.4	671	1.93
Rubidium	39.3	688	1.53
Indium	156.6	2,072	7.31

A chemistry student notes that gallium has the largest difference between its boiling point and its melting point among the elements in the table.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the statement?

A: 2,204 deg C, which is the highest boiling point among the four elements.

B: 29.8 deg C, which is the lowest melting point among the four elements.

C: 2,174.2 deg C, compared to a difference of 642.6 deg C for cesium.

D: 1,915.4 deg C, compared to a difference of 2,174.2 deg C for indium.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Gallium: $2204 - 29.8 = 2174.2$. Indium: $2072 - 156.6 = 1915.4$. C correctly states gallium's difference AND provides a comparison. D reverses which element has the larger difference (claims indium = 2174.2, which is wrong). A and B give single values, not the difference. TRICK: D contains a calculation error that swaps the elements' values -- always verify the arithmetic.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Pollinator species	Visits/hr (native wildflower)	Visits/hr (ornamental garden)
Western honeybee	12	15
Bumblebee	18	7
Hoverfly	8	9
Sweat bee	14	4

Entomologist Claire Beaulieu concluded that native wildflower patches attract a wider range of frequent pollinators than ornamental gardens do.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Beaulieu's conclusion?

A: Hoverflies visited the ornamental garden more frequently than the native wildflower patch, at 9 and 8 visits per hour, respectively.

B: Western honeybees made the most visits per hour in the ornamental garden, at 15, compared to 12 in the native wildflower patch.

C: Sweat bees made 14 visits per hour in the native wildflower patch, the second-highest rate among all species in that habitat.

D: In the native wildflower patch, three of four species (bumblebee, sweat bee, and western honeybee) each made more than 10 visits per hour, whereas in the ornamental garden only the western honeybee exceeded that rate.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Wider range of frequent pollinators' means MORE species visiting at high rates. D shows 3 species above 10 visits in native vs. 1 in ornamental. A and B actually support the ornamental garden. C states a fact about native habitat but doesn't compare the two. TRICK: 'Wider range' = count how many species are frequent, not which species visits most.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Textile	Water usage (L/kg)	Carbon emissions (kg CO ₂ /kg)
Conventional cotton	10,000	8.0
Organic cotton	7,000	5.5
Polyester	17	9.5
Linen	6,000	3.8

A sustainability researcher wants to highlight that reducing water consumption does not always correspond to lower carbon emissions.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate the researcher's point?

A: Organic cotton uses less water than conventional cotton (7,000 vs 10,000 L/kg) and also produces lower carbon emissions (5.5 vs 8.0), showing the two metrics CAN decline together.

B: Polyester uses far less water than any other textile (17 L/kg) but produces the highest carbon emissions (9.5 kg CO₂/kg), showing that lowest water use and lowest emissions do not coincide.

C: Linen uses less water than conventional cotton and also has lower carbon emissions, suggesting both metrics can decrease together.

D: Conventional cotton has both high water usage and relatively high carbon emissions compared to organic cotton.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim: less water does NOT always mean less carbon. B shows polyester (lowest water by far) has the HIGHEST carbon. A, C, and D all show cases where the two metrics DO move together -- they WEAKEN the claim. TRICK: 'Does not always correspond' needs a counterexample -- a case where one decreases while the other increases.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Dialect region	% using 'pop'	% using 'soda'	% using 'coke'
Upper Midwest	82	10	5
Northeast	15	75	4
Southeast	8	18	68
Pacific Northwest	12	52	6

A sociolinguist observes that each region has a dominant term used by a clear majority of speakers. However, one region's dominant term also has the highest usage rate across all four regions.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to identify that region and term?

A: The Upper Midwest, where 82% of speakers use 'pop' -- the highest percentage for any single term in any region.

B: The Northeast, where 75% of speakers use 'soda.'

C: The Southeast, where 68% of speakers use 'coke.'

D: The Pacific Northwest, where 52% of speakers use 'soda.'

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 82% is the highest single percentage in the entire table. B (75%), C (68%), and D (52%) are all lower. The question asks for the highest usage rate 'across all four regions,' meaning the single biggest number. TRICK: Scan all 12 cells to find the maximum value, then identify its region and term.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: [Table]

Planet	Orbital period (Earth days)	Avg surface temp (deg C)
Kepler-442b	112	-40
Kepler-186f	130	-60
TOI-700d	37	5
Proxima Centauri b	11	-39

An astrobiologist notes that the exoplanet with the shortest orbital period does not have the highest average surface temperature.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the observation?

A: Kepler-186f has the longest orbital period at 130 days and the lowest average surface temperature at -60 deg C.

B: TOI-700d has both the shortest orbital period and the highest average surface temperature among the four exoplanets.

C: Proxima Centauri b has the shortest orbital period at 11 days but has an average surface temperature of -39 deg C, while TOI-700d, with an orbital period of 37 days, has the highest average surface temperature at 5 deg C.

D: Kepler-442b has an orbital period of 112 days and an average surface temperature of -40 deg C.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim: shortest period is NOT highest temp. C identifies the shortest-period planet (Proxima Centauri b, 11 days) and shows its temp (-39) is not the highest, then names the actual highest-temp planet (TOI-700d, 5 deg C). B CONTRADICTS the claim. A and D state true facts but don't address the disconnect. TRICK: The correct answer must identify BOTH the shortest-period planet AND the highest-temp planet to show they differ.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Soil amendment	Root length (cm), drought	Root length (cm), irrigated
None (control)	8.2	14.6
Biochar	12.7	15.1
Mycorrhizal fungi	15.3	15.8
Biochar + mycorrhizal	16.1	16.0

Plant physiologist Kenji Watanabe concluded that the benefit of soil amendments is greatest under drought conditions, as amendments substantially increase root length relative to the control under drought but produce only marginal gains when water is plentiful.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Watanabe's conclusion?

A: Mycorrhizal fungi produced the longest roots under irrigated conditions at 15.8 cm, suggesting effectiveness regardless of water availability.

B: The biochar + mycorrhizal treatment produced 16.1 cm and 16.0 cm under drought and irrigated conditions, indicating its effect is virtually the same regardless of water.

C: Under drought conditions, the biochar treatment increased root length to 12.7 cm from the control's 8.2 cm, and under irrigated conditions it increased root length to 15.1 cm from 14.6 cm.

D: Under drought, the biochar + mycorrhizal treatment yielded 16.1 cm vs. 8.2 cm for the control (a difference of 7.9 cm), whereas under irrigation the same treatment yielded 16.0 cm vs. 14.6 cm (a difference of only 1.4 cm).

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Watanabe's claim: amendments help MORE under drought. D shows the gap (amendment vs. control) is 7.9 cm in drought but only 1.4 cm when irrigated -- the comparison the claim requires. B actually WEAKENS the claim by showing equal effect in both conditions. C supports the claim partially but with a weaker example. TRICK: Compare the GAPS (treatment minus control) across conditions, not the raw values.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Species	Observed frequency	Expected frequency
Prairie dropseed	0.42	0.45
Big bluestem	0.28	0.30
Wild bergamot	0.05	0.12
Pale purple coneflower	0.03	0.10

Restoration ecologist Danielle Moreau concluded that while dominant grasses have recovered well, certain forb species remain substantially underrepresented.

Which choice best describes data from the table that support Moreau's conclusion?

A: Wild bergamot has an observed frequency of 0.05, less than half its expected frequency of 0.12, while the two grass species have higher observed frequencies.

B: Prairie dropseed and big bluestem have observed frequencies (0.42 and 0.28) close to their expected values (0.45 and 0.30), but wild bergamot and pale purple coneflower have observed frequencies (0.05 and 0.03) well below their expected values (0.12 and 0.10).

C: All four species have observed frequencies lower than their expected frequencies, indicating that the restoration has not been fully successful.

D: Prairie dropseed has the highest observed frequency at 0.42, consistent with its role as a dominant grass species.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Moreau's claim has TWO parts: grasses recovered well AND forbs are underrepresented. B addresses BOTH by showing grasses close to expected and forbs well below. A only addresses forbs. C overgeneralizes (the grasses are close, not far below). D only addresses grasses. TRICK: Two-part claims need two-part support.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Ice core layer	Depth(m)	Age (yr before present)	CO2 (ppm)	Methane (ppb)
Layer A	50	2,500	280	680
Layer B	120	8,000	230	450
Layer C	250	18,000	200	390
Layer D	400	42,000	195	380

Paleoclimatologist Ingrid Solheim concluded that CO2 and methane have generally increased together, with the most substantial joint increase occurring in the most recent transition.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Solheim's conclusion?

A: Layer A has the highest concentrations of both CO2 (280 ppm) and methane (680 ppb), confirming a general upward trend.

B: Between Layer D and Layer C, CO2 rose from 195 to 200 ppm and methane rose from 380 to 390 ppb -- the smallest concurrent increases.

C: The transition from Layer B to Layer A shows CO2 rising by 50 ppm and methane by 230 ppb -- the largest joint increase between any two consecutive layers.

D: Between Layer C and Layer B, CO2 rose by 30 ppm and methane by 60 ppb, whereas from Layer D to Layer C CO2 rose by only 5 ppm and methane by 10 ppb.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Solheim says the MOST SUBSTANTIAL JOINT INCREASE was in the MOST RECENT transition. C shows B-to-A had +50 ppm CO2 and +230 ppb methane -- the largest between any consecutive layers, and the most recent. A confirms the trend but doesn't show the 'most recent transition.' D shows acceleration but doesn't address the most recent period. TRICK: 'Most recent transition' = the jump from the second-youngest to the youngest layer.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Treatment	Bacteria (CFU/mL)	Day 0	Day 3	Day 7
Silver nanoparticles	5.0×10^6	2.1×10^4	1.5×10^3	
Copper nanoparticles	5.0×10^6	8.3×10^5	4.0×10^5	
Zinc oxide	5.0×10^6	1.9×10^6	9.2×10^5	
Untreated (control)	5.0×10^6	6.8×10^6	1.2×10^7	

Microbiologist Fatima El-Amin concluded that all three treatments reduced bacterial counts relative to the control, but silver nanoparticles were the most effective, achieving a reduction of several orders of magnitude by Day 7.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support El-Amin's conclusion?

- A: By Day 7, silver nanoparticles reduced the count to 1.5×10^3 from an initial 5.0×10^6 -- a reduction of more than three orders of magnitude -- while the control increased to 1.2×10^7 .
- B: By Day 3, all three treatments had lower counts than the control, but zinc oxide still had 1.9×10^6 , nearly as high as the initial count.
- C: Copper nanoparticles reduced the count to 4.0×10^5 by Day 7, a reduction of approximately one order of magnitude.
- D: The control group's count increased from 5.0×10^6 to 1.2×10^7 over seven days, demonstrating that untreated water allowed bacterial growth.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: El-Amin's claim: silver is MOST effective with SEVERAL orders of magnitude reduction. A shows silver going from 10^6 to 10^3 (3+ orders) while the control grew -- both parts of the claim. B, C, and D each address only ONE part. TRICK: 'Orders of magnitude' = powers of 10. Count the exponent difference: 10^6 to 10^3 = 3 orders.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Condition	Congruent trials (ms)	Incongruent trials (ms)
No distraction	340	420
Auditory distraction	355	490
Visual distraction	380	530
Dual distraction	410	610

Cognitive psychologist Lena Strand concluded that distractions increase response times in all trial types, but the effect is disproportionately larger for incongruent trials than for congruent trials.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Strand's conclusion?

A: The dual distraction condition produced the highest response times for both congruent (410 ms) and incongruent (610 ms) trials.

B: Visual distraction produced higher response times than auditory distraction for both trial types, suggesting visual interference is more disruptive.

C: Mean response times for congruent trials ranged from 340 ms to 410 ms, an increase of 70 ms, while incongruent trial times in dual distraction were 610 ms.

D: In the no-distraction condition, the gap between incongruent and congruent response times is 80 ms, but in dual distraction this gap widens to 200 ms, showing distractions amplify the difficulty of incongruent trials far more than congruent trials.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: 'Disproportionately larger for incongruent' means the gap between congruent and incongruent WIDENS as distractions increase. D compares the gaps: 80 ms with no distraction vs 200 ms with dual distraction. A shows absolute values but not the disproportionate effect. C mixes different comparisons. TRICK: 'Disproportionate' = compare the DIFFERENCE between trial types across conditions, not raw values.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Country	GDP per capita (\$)	Mean life satisfaction (1-10)
Country A	82,000	7.4
Country B	48,000	7.6
Country C	12,000	6.1
Country D	5,500	5.8
Country E	3,200	6.3

Economist Rajesh Banerjee concluded that while life satisfaction generally increases with GDP per capita, the relationship is not perfectly linear, since some lower-income countries report higher satisfaction than wealthier peers.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Banerjee's conclusion?

A: Country A has the highest GDP per capita and a high satisfaction score, while Country D has low GDP and low satisfaction, confirming a strong positive relationship.

B: Country B has lower GDP than Country A (\$48,000 vs \$82,000) yet reports higher satisfaction (7.6 vs 7.4), and Country E (\$3,200 GDP) reports higher satisfaction (6.3) than Country D (\$5,500, satisfaction 5.8).

C: Countries C, D, and E all have GDP below \$15,000 and satisfaction below 6.5, suggesting a threshold below which satisfaction is uniformly low.

D: Country A has the highest GDP per capita at \$82,000 and Country E has the lowest at \$3,200, showing a wide range of national wealth.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Banerjee's claim: generally positive BUT not perfectly linear. B shows TWO exceptions: B > A despite lower GDP, and E > D despite lower GDP. A supports only the 'generally positive' part, ignoring the nonlinear part. C overgeneralizes (E is actually higher than D). TRICK: 'Not perfectly linear' needs exceptions to the pattern -- cases where lower GDP has higher satisfaction.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Adhesive	Strength dry (MPa)	Strength 24hr (MPa)	Strength 72hr (MPa)
Epoxy resin	28.5	24.1	19.8
Cyanoacrylate	22.0	9.6	3.2
Polyurethane	15.4	14.8	14.1
Marine silicone	8.2	6.5	4.8

Materials engineer Sofia Lindgren concluded that while epoxy resin offers the highest initial bond strength, polyurethane is the best choice for prolonged submersion because its bond strength remains the most stable over time.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Lindgren's conclusion?

- A: Epoxy resin's strength declined from 28.5 to 19.8 MPa after 72 hours (a decrease of 8.7 MPa), whereas polyurethane declined from 15.4 to 14.1 MPa (a decrease of only 1.3 MPa).
B: Marine silicone's strength dropped from 8.2 to 4.8 MPa after 72 hours, a decrease of over 40%, making it the least stable adhesive.
C: Cyanoacrylate experienced the largest decline, dropping from 22.0 to 3.2 MPa after 72 hours.
D: Polyurethane's bond strength after 72 hours of submersion (14.1 MPa) exceeded cyanoacrylate's 72-hour strength (3.2 MPa).

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Lindgren compares epoxy (highest initial) to polyurethane (most stable). A shows both: epoxy starts highest but drops 8.7 MPa, while polyurethane drops only 1.3 MPa. B and C discuss other adhesives. D compares polyurethane to cyanoacrylate, not epoxy. TRICK: The claim names two specific materials -- the support must compare those same two on the claimed metric (stability over time).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Neighborhood	Median income (\$)	Avg commute (min)	Green space/capita (sq m)
Westbrook	92,000	22	45
Elm Terrace	64,000	38	18
Riverside	55,000	41	52
Northgate	78,000	30	30

Urban planner Mei Chen concluded that access to green space does not consistently track with household income: some lower-income neighborhoods have more green space per capita than wealthier ones.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Chen's conclusion?

A: Westbrook has the highest income (\$92,000) and 45 sq m of green space, while Northgate has the second-highest income (\$78,000) and 30 sq m -- both higher-income areas have moderate green space.

B: Elm Terrace has both a lower income and less green space than Westbrook, showing that income and green space CAN be correlated.

C: Riverside has the second-lowest income (\$55,000) but the highest green space per capita (52 sq m), exceeding Westbrook (\$92,000, 45 sq m) and Northgate (\$78,000, 30 sq m).

D: Northgate has a higher income (\$78,000) than Riverside (\$55,000) but a shorter commute (30 vs 41 min), suggesting income is tied to commuting, not green space.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Chen says lower-income areas can have MORE green space. C shows Riverside (lower income) has more green space than both wealthier neighborhoods. A shows a partial pattern but doesn't demonstrate the disconnect. B actually SUPPORTS correlation. TRICK: 'Does not consistently track' needs a specific counterexample showing a lower-income area with higher green space.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Model	Accuracy (training)	Accuracy (new data)	Processing time (s)
Linear regression	78%	76%	0.3
Decision tree	92%	71%	1.2
Random forest	95%	84%	8.5
Neural network	98%	86%	45.0

Data scientist Owen Park concluded that the most complex model does not offer the best trade-off between predictive performance on new data and computational efficiency.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Park's conclusion?

- A: The decision tree achieves 92% accuracy on training data but only 71% on new data, indicating severe overfitting.
- B: Linear regression has the shortest processing time at 0.3 seconds but the lowest accuracy on new data at 76%.
- C: The random forest achieves 95% accuracy on training data and 84% on new data, making it the overall best model.
- D: The neural network achieves 86% accuracy on new data, only 2 points above the random forest's 84%, but requires more than five times the processing time (45.0 s vs 8.5 s).

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Park's claim: the MOST COMPLEX model (neural network) does NOT have the best TRADE-OFF. D shows the neural network gains only 2% accuracy over random forest but costs 5x the processing time -- a poor trade-off. C claims random forest is 'best overall' but doesn't explain why. A discusses overfitting, not trade-offs. TRICK: 'Trade-off' means comparing what you gain vs what you spend. A 2% accuracy gain for a 5x cost increase is a poor trade-off.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Fertilizer	Yield Yr1 (kg)	Yield Yr2 (kg)	Yield Yr3 (kg)	Soil N Yr3 (mg/kg)
Synthetic NPK	52	54	48	12
Compost	38	44	50	28
Green manure	35	42	49	25
No fertilizer	30	28	25	8

Agronomist Lucia Fernandez concluded that organic amendments initially produce lower yields than synthetic fertilizers but demonstrate an improving trajectory over time, likely because they build soil nitrogen reserves.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Fernandez's conclusion?

A: Synthetic NPK produced the highest yield in Year 1 (52 kg) but declined to 48 by Year 3, while compost yields rose from 38 to 50 and compost-treated soil had 28 mg/kg of nitrogen, compared to 12 for synthetic NPK.

B: Green manure and compost both produced lower yields than synthetic NPK in all three years.

C: The no-fertilizer control showed declining yields (30 to 25) and the lowest soil nitrogen (8 mg/kg), confirming some fertilization is necessary.

D: By Year 3, compost (50 kg) exceeded synthetic NPK (48 kg), but green manure (49 kg) was essentially equivalent to both.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Fernandez's claim has THREE parts: (1) organic starts lower, (2) organic improves over time, (3) because of nitrogen. A shows all three: synthetic starts higher but declines, compost rises, and nitrogen is higher in compost soil. B is factually incorrect (compost exceeds synthetic in Year 3). D addresses trajectory but not nitrogen. TRICK: Multi-part claims need multi-part evidence. Count the claim's elements and check that the answer addresses each one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 41

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Period	Shipwrecks	Avg cargo (tonnes)	% carrying ceramics
200 BCE-100 CE	48	75	35%
100-300 CE	112	140	62%
300-500 CE	67	95	48%
500-700 CE	23	60	29%

Maritime archaeologist Nikos Andreou concluded that both the volume and the diversity of maritime trade peaked during 100-300 CE and subsequently declined.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Andreou's conclusion?

A: The period 200 BCE-100 CE had 48 shipwrecks, fewer than 112 in 100-300 CE, showing trade increased before the peak.

B: The period 100-300 CE had the highest shipwrecks (112), largest cargo (140 tonnes), and highest ceramics percentage (62%), while all three metrics decreased in subsequent periods.

C: Between 300-500 CE and 500-700 CE, shipwrecks dropped from 67 to 23 and cargo fell from 95 to 60 tonnes, confirming post-peak decline.

D: The ceramics percentage declined from 62% to 29%, but this might reflect cargo preference changes rather than trade volume.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: 'Peaked and subsequently declined' requires showing the peak AND the decline in all metrics. B shows 100-300 CE was highest on ALL THREE measures and that all decreased afterward. A only shows the rise. C only shows part of the decline. D introduces doubt.

TRICK: 'Peak and decline' claims need the peak value AND the declining trend for each metric mentioned.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Tree species	Mean DBH (cm)	Urban	Suburban	Rural
Red maple	18.4	26.1	35.8	
White oak	15.2	28.7	42.3	
Eastern hemlock	12.0	19.5	31.4	
American sycamore	22.6	30.4	38.9	

Forestry researcher Tanisha Brooks concluded that urban environments constrain tree growth across all species but that the magnitude of this effect varies: some species show a larger proportional size reduction in urban settings.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Brooks's conclusion?

A: All four species have smaller mean DBH in urban settings than in rural settings, confirming that urbanization constrains growth uniformly.

B: American sycamore has the largest urban DBH at 22.6 cm, suggesting it tolerates urban conditions best.

C: White oak's urban DBH (15.2 cm) is approximately 36% of its rural DBH (42.3 cm), whereas American sycamore's urban DBH (22.6 cm) is approximately 58% of its rural value (38.9 cm), showing different proportional reductions.

D: Eastern hemlock has the lowest DBH in all three settings, indicating it is the smallest species overall.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Brooks says the MAGNITUDE of urbanization's effect VARIES among species. C shows white oak loses ~64% of its rural size vs. sycamore losing ~42% -- different proportional impacts. A says growth is constrained UNIFORMLY, which contradicts Brooks. B and D discuss absolute size, not proportional reduction. TRICK: 'Varies among species' = compare the PROPORTIONAL reduction (urban/rural ratio) for different species, not absolute values.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 43

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Student group	Pre-test	Post-test Method A	Post-test Method B
Low (below 40)	32	58	49
Mid (40-70)	55	72	74
High (above 70)	78	85	88

Education researcher Samuel Adeyemi concluded that Method A is more effective for low-performing students, while Method B benefits higher-performing students more.

Which choice best describes data that support Adeyemi's conclusion?

A: High-performing students scored 85 under Method A and 88 under Method B, a difference of only 3 points, which may not be significant.

B: Mid-performing students scored higher under Method B (74) than Method A (72), suggesting Method B is better for all above the lowest tier.

C: Low-performing students had the largest overall gains regardless of method, suggesting both methods help those with the most room to improve.

D: Under Method A, low-performing students gained 26 points (32 to 58), vs. only 17 points under Method B (32 to 49), whereas high-performing students gained 10 points under Method B (78 to 88) vs. 7 under Method A (78 to 85).

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Adeyemi's claim has TWO parts: Method A better for low-performers AND Method B better for high-performers. D shows both: low-performers gain more under A (+26 vs +17) and high-performers gain more under B (+10 vs +7). A addresses only high-performers. B suggests Method B is universally better. C doesn't compare methods. TRICK: Compare GAINS (post minus pre), not raw post-test scores -- a higher post-test score might just reflect a higher starting point.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 44

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Catalyst	Rate at 25C (mol/L.s)	Rate at 50C (mol/L.s)	Selectivity (%)
Platinum	0.042	0.089	92
Palladium	0.038	0.081	88
Nickel	0.015	0.058	74
Iron	0.009	0.052	65

Chemical engineer Hana Kovacova concluded that while all catalysts improve at higher temperatures, the premium catalysts (platinum and palladium) offer diminishing marginal returns in rate improvement relative to their selectivity advantage.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Kovacova's conclusion?

- A: Platinum's rate roughly doubles from 25 to 50 deg C (0.042 to 0.089), while nickel's rate nearly quadruples (0.015 to 0.058), yet platinum's selectivity (92%) far exceeds nickel's (74%) -- the rate gap narrows at higher temperatures even as the selectivity gap persists.
- B: All four catalysts show higher rates at 50 deg C than at 25 deg C, confirming temperature accelerates the reaction.
- C: Palladium has selectivity of 88%, close to platinum's 92%, but lower reaction rates at both temperatures.
- D: Iron has the lowest rate and selectivity, making it the least suitable catalyst.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: 'Diminishing marginal returns in rate improvement RELATIVE TO selectivity advantage' means cheaper catalysts gain more speed at higher temperatures, closing the rate gap, while the selectivity gap remains. A shows this: nickel gains proportionally more speed than platinum, but platinum's selectivity advantage persists. TRICK: 'Relative to' means comparing two different metrics' trajectories -- rate convergence vs. selectivity persistence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Decade	Written grammars published	Audio-only documentation	Newly extinct languages
1970s	85	40	12
1980s	110	95	18
1990s	145	210	35
2000s	130	420	62

Linguist Yara Boulos concluded that although documentation efforts intensified, the rate of language extinction accelerated even faster, suggesting documentation alone is insufficient to prevent language loss.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Boulos's conclusion?

A: Written grammars increased from 85 in the 1970s to 145 in the 1990s but then decreased to 130 in the 2000s, indicating documentation efforts have plateaued.

B: Newly extinct languages grew from 12 in the 1970s to 62 in the 2000s -- more than a fivefold increase -- while written grammars grew from 85 to 130, less than doubling over the same period.

C: Audio documentation increased from 40 in the 1970s to 420 in the 2000s, outpacing written grammars.

D: In the 2000s, 62 languages went extinct while 130 grammars were published, the highest and second-highest numbers respectively.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Boulos compares the RATE of documentation growth vs. the RATE of extinction growth. B shows extinction grew 5x while documentation grew less than 2x -- extinction outpaced documentation. A only addresses documentation. C compares two documentation types. D gives one year's snapshot, not growth rates. TRICK: 'Accelerated even faster' means comparing GROWTH RATES, not absolute numbers.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Irrigation method	Water (L/hectare/day)	Yield (tonnes/ha)	Soil salinity 5yr (dS/m)
Flood irrigation	8,500	6.2	4.8
Sprinkler	5,200	6.0	3.1
Drip irrigation	3,100	6.5	1.9
Subsurface drip	2,800	6.4	1.5

Agricultural engineer Carmen Delgado concluded that drip-based methods offer comparable or higher yields while dramatically reducing water consumption and soil salinization.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Delgado's conclusion?

A: Drip irrigation uses 3,100 L/hectare/day and produces the highest yield at 6.5 tonnes/ha, while flood irrigation uses 8,500 L/hectare/day yet produces only 6.2 tonnes/ha with the highest salinity at 4.8 dS/m, compared to 1.9 for drip.

B: Subsurface drip uses the least water (2,800 L) and has the lowest salinity (1.5 dS/m), but its yield (6.4) is slightly below drip irrigation's (6.5).

C: Sprinkler irrigation uses roughly 60% of flood's water and results in lower salinity, though its yield of 6.0 is the lowest among all four methods.

D: Flood irrigation has the highest water usage and highest salinity, suggesting high water use directly causes soil degradation.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Delgado's claim is about DRIP methods vs. CONVENTIONAL methods on THREE metrics: yield, water, and salinity. A directly compares drip vs. flood on all three, showing drip wins on each. B discusses internal differences between drip types. C discusses sprinkler, not drip. D makes a causal claim not in the original argument. TRICK: The claim specifies 'drip-based methods' -- the answer must compare drip to a conventional method, not sprinkler to flood.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 47

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Habitat type	Species richness	Evenness (0-1)	Invasive spp (%)
Old-growth forest	42	0.85	3%
Secondary (30 yr)	35	0.72	8%
Plantation forest	18	0.45	22%
Urban park	24	0.60	15%

Conservation biologist Marco Reyes concluded that habitat disturbance reduces species count and equitability while increasing vulnerability to invasive species.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Reyes's conclusion?

- A: Secondary forests have 35 species with evenness 0.72, showing that 30 years of recovery is insufficient to restore old-growth diversity.
- B: Urban parks have higher species richness (24) than plantation forests (18) but lower evenness (0.60 vs 0.45), which actually shows evenness is HIGHER in urban parks.
- C: Old-growth forest has the highest richness (42), highest evenness (0.85), and lowest invasive percentage (3%), while plantation forest -- the most disturbed habitat -- has the lowest richness (18), lowest evenness (0.45), and highest invasive percentage (22%).
- D: The invasive species percentage increases from 3% to 22% across the disturbance gradient, but this could reflect deliberate non-native planting rather than invasive colonization.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Reyes's claim links THREE metrics to disturbance. C shows the two extremes (least disturbed vs. most disturbed) and all three metrics moving in the predicted direction. A addresses only one comparison. B contains an error in its reasoning (0.60 IS higher than 0.45). D introduces doubt about the claim. TRICK: Compare the least-disturbed and most-disturbed habitats across all stated metrics.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Year	Print (%)	Online news (%)	Social media (%)	Podcasts/audio (%)
2012	42	35	15	8
2016	28	38	24	10
2020	15	32	38	15
2024	9	26	42	23

Media researcher Anton Voronov concluded that social media has displaced print as the dominant news source, but the transition has been accompanied by a steady rise in audio-based consumption, suggesting fragmentation rather than simple migration.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Voronov's conclusion?

A: Print fell from 42% to 9% while social media rose from 15% to 42%, indicating a simple transfer from one platform to another.

B: Online news peaked at 38% in 2016 and declined to 26% by 2024, suggesting digital news consumption as a whole is declining.

C: By 2024, social media (42%) and podcasts (23%) combined to 65%, dwarfing print (9%).

D: Social media grew from 15% to 42%, overtaking print (42% to 9%), but podcasts nearly tripled (8% to 23%) while online news declined (35% to 26%), showing audience dispersal across multiple platforms rather than consolidation.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Voronov's claim: social media displaced print (part 1) BUT also fragmentation, not simple migration (part 2). A supports only part 1 and actually CONTRADICTS part 2 by calling it 'simple transfer.' D shows BOTH the displacement AND the fragmentation (podcasts rising, online declining = dispersal). C just adds numbers without showing the fragmentation pattern. TRICK: 'Fragmentation' means multiple platforms changing in different directions, not just two platforms swapping audiences.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Population	Sample	Mean vit D (ng/mL)	Std dev	% deficient (<20)
Office workers	280	22.4	8.1	38%
Outdoor laborers	310	34.7	6.3	9%
Night-shift	195	18.6	9.4	52%
Retired (65+)	260	25.1	10.2	31%

Epidemiologist Dr. Celine Montague concluded that sunlight exposure during working hours is a stronger predictor of vitamin D levels than age, noting that groups with limited daytime outdoor exposure show lower means and higher deficiency rates.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to support Montague's conclusion?

A: Office workers had a mean of 22.4, above the deficiency threshold, yet 38% were classified as deficient, indicating the mean alone does not capture the distribution.

B: Outdoor laborers had the highest mean (34.7) and lowest deficiency (9%), while night-shift nurses and office workers -- both with limited daytime outdoor exposure -- had lower means (18.6 and 22.4) and higher deficiency (52% and 38%), despite being younger on average than the retired adults (mean 25.1, deficiency 31%).

C: Retired adults had the highest standard deviation (10.2), suggesting age introduces more variability than occupation.

D: Night-shift nurses had the lowest mean (18.6) and highest deficiency (52%), confirming nighttime work is harmful.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Montague's claim: SUNLIGHT EXPOSURE is a stronger predictor than AGE. B shows the occupational exposure pattern (outdoor > office/night-shift) AND addresses age by noting retirees (older) have BETTER levels than younger indoor workers. A discusses distributions, not the claim. C supports the opposite conclusion. D only addresses one group. TRICK: 'Stronger predictor than age' requires showing that the age factor is overridden by the exposure factor.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 50

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Evidence (Data, Graphs, Tables)

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: [Table]

Scenario	Temp increase by 2100 (deg C)	Sea level rise (cm)	Coral reefs at severe risk
SSP1	1.5	30	10%
SSP2	2.5	55	35%
SSP3	3.5	80	75%
SSP5	4.5	110	98%

Climate scientist Dr. Rajan Gupta concluded that the relationship between emissions and ecological impact is nonlinear: even moderate temperature increases trigger disproportionately large increases in coral reef risk, particularly in the mid-range of projected warming.

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to illustrate Gupta's conclusion?

- A: Between SSP1 and SSP2, a 1.0 deg C increase raises reef risk by 25 points (10% to 35%), whereas between SSP3 and SSP5 the same increase raises risk by 23 points (75% to 98%), suggesting a roughly consistent rate.
- B: Under SSP5, 98% of coral reefs are at severe risk, compared to 10% under SSP1, confirming higher emissions lead to greater damage.
- C: Between SSP2 and SSP3, a 1.0 deg C increase corresponds to a 40-point rise in reef risk (35% to 75%) -- larger than the 25-point rise between SSP1 and SSP2 (10% to 35%) -- demonstrating that in the mid-range, each degree of warming produces disproportionately greater impact.
- D: Sea level rise increases from 30 to 110 cm, roughly proportional to the threefold temperature increase, indicating a linear relationship.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Gupta says 'nonlinear' and 'disproportionately large in the mid-range.' C shows that the same 1 deg C increase produces a 40-point reef risk jump in the mid-range vs. 25 points at the low end -- the mid-range response is disproportionate. A actually shows roughly CONSISTENT responses, weakening the claim. B shows the overall trend but not the nonlinearity. D describes a LINEAR relationship. TRICK: 'Nonlinear' means the same input (1 deg C) produces DIFFERENT outputs at different points in the range.

END QUESTION